

Name: _____ Date: _____

Amira's science project compared two bean plants. She set both pots in the same corner and gave them the same water. After four days, the plant beside the bookshelf had wilted. Its stem curved toward the glass.

Amira examined the corner and noticed the blind was pulled down each afternoon. The bookshelf plant spent those hours in shadow. She wrote in her log that the plants had the same water but different light.

With her teacher's permission, she raised the blind after lunch and turned both pots a little each day. She did not add extra water, so light would be the only change. Three days later the wilted stem had straightened.

Amira added a sentence to her board: the plant was not sick. It had been searching for sun. She left the blind raised for the rest of the week and still checked both plants every morning before class.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

After a hard rain, the path beside the creek was a long puddle. Jordan was walking to the bridge when he saw leaves packed against a metal drain. Water had nowhere to go, so it spread across the gravel.

Jordan did not pull the grate up by himself. He found the park worker, Ms. Alvarez, and showed her the clog. Together they lifted the grate. Jordan raked leaves into a bucket while Ms. Alvarez cleared the mud with a shovel.

The water began to drop. Jordan stayed until the path showed again. Ms. Alvarez thanked him and set the bucket of leaves by the compost bin.

On the way home, Jordan told his family why the puddle had not been just a puddle. A blocked drain had turned the path into a pond. He said he would check that grate after the next storm. Jordan waved as he left the path.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

The class play was that afternoon, and the lead, Priya, could barely speak. She had cheered too loudly at the morning game. Ms. Brooks looked at the cast and asked who knew the part.

Camila had listened from the side during every practice, mouthing the lines while she waited for her small scene. She hesitated, then said she could try. At lunch she walked the stage alone and spoke the opening three times.

When the curtain opened, Camila's hands shook. She looked at Priya in the front row, took a breath, and began. She missed one word, paused, and kept going. The class followed the story anyway.

After the bow, Priya whispered that the pause had sounded like part of the line. Camila smiled. Watching had been practice, even when she was not in the spotlight. She kept the script in her folder for the next show. She was glad she had tried.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Switched Backpacks

Grade 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

On the bus home, Malik grabbed a blue backpack from the seat and did not look at the tag. At his kitchen table he unzipped it and found a math folder with another name: Andre Ellis. His own backpack, with the tablet the class used for reading, was still on the bus.

Malik called the number written inside Andre's folder. Andre had made the same mistake and was standing in his own kitchen with Malik's bag. They agreed to meet at the school office before it locked.

Ms. Nguyen watched them trade bags and checked the tablet. The screen lit up, and nothing was cracked. Malik slid his reading folder back into the right pocket.

He looped a bright ribbon through his zipper that night. The next afternoon he checked the tag before he stepped off the bus. Andre did the same with his own bag. Both boys laughed with relief.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

A small cry came from the storm drain by the playground. Elena knelt and saw a kitten pressed against the metal, too scared to climb the wet side. She did not reach in. She ran for Mr. Cole, the custodian.

Mr. Cole brought a towel and a flashlight. He lay on the sidewalk, spoke softly, and slid the towel down like a ramp. The kitten crept up and into Elena's arms. A collar sat under the wet fur, and the tag was still readable: "Pip. Call Rosa."

Elena used the office phone. Rosa arrived out of breath and scooped Pip up, explaining that the kitten had slipped out during the rain. She thanked them both.

Elena washed her hands and wrote the afternoon in her journal. Asking for help had been faster than trying to be brave alone. She told her class about the towel ramp the next day too.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

The math team met in the gym to explain a puzzle at the assembly. Ten minutes before they went on, their note cards were gone. A draft from the open door had blown the stack off the bleachers.

Noah dropped to his knees and found two cards under the bottom row. The other three were smeared from a wet shoe print. He could read the titles but not the middle steps.

His partner, Lila, said they still remembered the puzzle because they had built it. They whispered the steps in order: draw the chart, test one change, and check the result. Noah wrote fresh cards in big letters.

On stage, the chart made sense. A younger student even asked a question they could answer. The lost cards had been a scare, not the end of the explanation. Noah clipped the new cards into his folder before he left the gym.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Tomatoes After the Rain

Grade 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

The community garden tomatoes had split overnight. Heavy rain had soaked the ripe fruit, and the skins had burst in pale lines. If the class waited until Friday's harvest, many of the tomatoes would spoil on the vine.

Sofia, the garden helper, brought a basket and a pair of scissors. She showed the group how to clip only the split ones, leaving the firm green tomatoes to finish. Juice stained her hands, but the basket filled quickly.

At lunch the class rinsed the pieces and set them out with salt on a tray. Students who usually skipped tomatoes took a cup. Sofia wrote "Pick ripe fruit after heavy rain" on the garden clipboard.

The plants looked thinner, but they were healthier. The next rain would not have so much soft fruit waiting to break. Sofia checked the vines again before she went inside. She was glad they had not waited.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

During quiet reading, Andre noticed the classroom fish hanging near the top of the tank. Their mouths broke the surface again and again. The filter, which usually hummed, was silent.

He did not tap the glass. He told Mr. Chen, who lifted the filter lid and found it packed with gray gunk. The fish were not playing. They were hunting for air.

Mr. Chen rinsed the filter in tank water, not soap, and Andre held the bucket steady. When the filter clicked back on, a stream of bubbles rolled through the tank. By the end of reading, the fish had dropped to the middle of the water.

Andre added "Check the hum" to the tank job list. A quiet filter was a problem, not a peaceful sound. Andre listened for the hum every morning after that. The fish stayed in the middle of the tank, and the water stayed clear too.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

The concert started in twenty minutes, and Diego's trumpet was not in the band room cubby. He had practiced that morning and was sure he had set the case on the bench. Now the bench held only a stack of music.

Diego checked the practice rooms and the office. Then he opened the closet where extra stands were stored. His case was on the floor, shoved back when someone rolled a cart inside. The latch was still closed.

He had just enough time to warm up in the hall. His first notes wobbled, then settled. When the band entered, Diego watched the director's hands and came in on the beat.

After the concert he slid the case onto the cubby shelf, not the bench. A shelf could not be cleared by a rolling cart. Diego checked the cubby again before he left the band room. His case was still there.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Lila's little brother borrowed her library book and set a cup too close to the page. By the time Lila saw it, apple juice had soaked the chapter about bridges. The paper buckled and the ink blurred.

She did not try to hide the book in her backpack. At the library desk she showed Ms. Ortiz the stain and said it was an accident at home. Ms. Ortiz nodded and explained that damaged books have to be replaced.

Lila used money she had saved from feeding a neighbor's cat. She paid for the copy, and Ms. Ortiz ordered another one. Lila checked out a different bridges book so she could finish her report.

That night she gave her brother a plastic cup with a lid. The next book stayed on the table, far from any drink. Lila finished her bridges report with the new copy. She turned it in on time.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

A Plan for the Mud

Grade 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

The soccer field was mud from sideline to sideline. Passes that usually skimmed the grass stopped dead. Hector's team was down by one, and long kicks kept the ball with the other side.

Hector called his teammates into a huddle. He said they should pass short, to the nearest foot, and stay out of the deep puddle by the goal. The keeper, Amina, would roll the ball instead of punting it into the mess.

The plan was slower, but the ball stayed with them. Hector tapped a pass to Jonah, who slid it into the corner. The game ended tied. Nobody cheered like it was a championship, but they shook hands standing up instead of slipping.

Hector thanked Amina for the calm rolls. Mud had changed the game, so they had changed the plan. Hector wrote the short-pass idea in his notebook that night. He wanted to remember it.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

The trail map had slipped out of Rosa's pocket somewhere on the switchbacks. The group stopped at a split where both paths looked the same. Voices got quick and worried.

Mr. Ellis reminded them not to scatter. Rosa remembered the ranger's morning talk: the creek stayed on the left all the way to the meadow. They listened and heard water over rocks. Rosa pointed left, and the group walked single file, watching for the blue trail marks she had forgotten until then.

The marks appeared again beside a fallen log. Ten minutes later the ranger met them at the meadow, already walking back to check on slow groups. Rosa told him about the map.

He handed her a spare and showed her the zip pocket on her pack. She put the map there before she took another step. The group stayed together for the rest of the walk. Rosa led them.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

The dough for family dinner sat in the bowl like a pale stone. Sam had followed the card, but the kitchen was cold because a window was open. An hour passed, and the dough had barely moved.

Sam's grandmother pressed it with a finger and shook her head. She did not throw it out. She set the bowl on a rack above the warm stove, covered it with a damp towel, and told Sam to wait without peeking every minute.

The next time they looked, the dough had domed over the rim. Sam shaped it into a pan. While it baked, the kitchen smelled like the bakery down the street.

At dinner the bread was not perfect, but it was theirs. Sam wrote "warm spot, damp towel" on the recipe card so the next cold day would not stop the rise. He left the card where the family could see it.

Setting**Character****Beginning (State Problem)****Middle (Three Events)**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____

Date: _____

The school paper was ready for the copier, stacked in the office. Jade read her article one last time and felt her stomach drop. She had written that the garden club met on Thursday. The club met on Tuesday. Fifty copies would spread the mistake.

Jade did not wait for someone else to notice. She told Mr. Patel, who ran the copier, and showed him the sentence. He had not started the machine. Together they opened the file, changed Thursday to Tuesday, and printed a single test page.

Jade checked the date, the names, and the lunch menu before she nodded. Then the copier began its steady shuffle. Students would arrive at the garden on the right day.

She kept a pencil in her pocket after that and read every article backward, sentence by sentence, once more. The Tuesday meeting was full. Many students arrived with garden tools and smiles.

Setting**Character****Beginning (State Problem)****Middle (Three Events)**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

A Ramp for the Cart

Grade 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

The garden gate had a step that was only as high as a brick, but it stopped the supply cart. Wheels bumped, jars rattled, and water sloshed onto Priya's shoes. Carrying everything by hand took three trips.

Priya asked the garden lead, Ms. Brooks, if they could build a ramp. They measured the step and found a spare board in the shed. It was long enough to slope gently, not steeply. Priya sanded the rough edge while Ms. Brooks braced the board so it would not slide.

They tested the cart with one empty tub first. It rolled up without a jolt. Then they tried the full water jug. Priya kept one hand on the rail and one on the cart.

The next work day, the whole club used the ramp. The step was still there for people who wanted it. The cart finally had a way in. Priya left the board by the gate for the next work day.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

The class time capsule would not latch. The wooden lid had swollen after a night in a damp closet, and the metal clasp missed its loop by a finger's width. Inside were letters the students wanted opened in ten years.

Owen suggested forcing it. Mr. Ellis said force would crack the wood. Instead they set the box, lid open, in the sunny hallway and aimed a fan across it. Every hour someone checked that the papers stayed inside and dry.

By the end of the day the lid sat flat. The clasp clicked. Owen still worried about another wet night, so he wrapped a piece of twine around the box as a backup and tucked the knot underneath.

They stored the capsule on a high shelf in the dry office. The letters could wait. The box could finally close. Owen wrote the shelf number on a class note so no one would move it.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Field Day Under the Awning

Grade 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

Thunder rolled just as the relay teams lined up. The sky that had been pale all morning turned the color of a bruise. Ms. Alvarez blew a whistle and pointed to the wide awning beside the gym.

Students groaned about the canceled races. Then Ms. Alvarez said they were not canceled, only moved. She marked a shorter track with cones under the awning, away from the metal poles. The relay would be two legs instead of four, so nobody would crowd the dry strip.

Jonah's team complained, then practiced the handoff twice in the small space. When they ran, the baton did not drop. They did not win, but they finished. Rain tapped the awning like drums.

Jonah was soaked only at the edges of his sleeves. Field day had shrunk, but it had not disappeared. Jonah still talked about the handoff on the ride home. He was proud of it.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Wallet on the Bench

Grade 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

A brown wallet sat on the park bench where Elena had tied her shoe. She looked around the playground, but the family who had been there was gone. The wallet was fat with cards, and leaving it felt wrong.

Elena carried it to the rec center desk instead of digging through it on the sidewalk. The worker, Mr. Shah, opened it with her watching. A student ID from the middle school showed a name: Luis Ortega. The office phone list had his house.

Luis and his dad arrived before Elena finished her water bottle. Luis checked the cards and let out a long breath. Nothing was missing. His dad thanked Elena and Mr. Shah for not leaving the wallet on the bench.

Elena walked home lighter. She had not saved a fortune. She had kept a stranger's afternoon from getting worse. Mr. Shah said the desk was always the right place for a found wallet.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Wilting Lettuce

Grade 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

The lettuce bed looked tired. Outer leaves drooped even though the morning had been cool. Andre knelt and pushed a finger into the soil. It was dry a knuckle down. The sprinkler had been aimed at the path, not the bed, for three days.

Andre told the garden club at lunch. They did not flood the plants all at once. He showed them how to water at the roots, slowly, until the soil held together without turning to mud. Then they moved the sprinkler and set a can on the path as a marker.

The next afternoon the leaves had lifted. Andre wrote a watering map: lettuce on odd days, tomatoes on even days, and a check of where the sprinkler actually pointed.

A map was a small thing. It kept the next dry week from sneaking up on the bed. Andre posted the map where the whole club could read it.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Morning Announcement

Grade 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

The morning announcements were usually quick, but today the script was Camila's. She had written three sentences about the book drive. Standing by the office microphone, she felt her mouth go dry. The first practice, alone in the hall, had come out in a rush.

Mr. Patel let her try twice more before the bell. The second time she still stumbled on "donations." The third time she paused after each sentence, the way he showed her, and the word came out whole. He nodded and set the speaker on.

Camila heard her own voice in the hall. It was smaller than she expected and clearer than she feared. When she sat down in class, two students asked where to bring books.

She taped the script into her notebook with the pauses marked. The next announcement would still make her nervous. She would not meet it for the first time at the microphone.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)